

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Remember the magic words: service with a smile!



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Are you good at offering advice to your friends?
- Do you take your friends' advice?
- Do you change your mind easily about a decision you want to make?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about customer service.
- I can offer advice and solutions.
- I can persuade someone to change his or her mind.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa shares a few tips on how to **keep your cool*** with rude customers.

* You "keep your cool" when you don't get stressed in stressful situations.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** Sarah, I would like to go over what happened yesterday with you.
Sarah: I'm sorry I sounded rude to the customer. It won't happen again.
Vanessa: It's not your fault, don't worry. His behaviour was out of line. However, we work in the service industry, and we ought to treat our clients with the appropriate care. Our reputation depends on it.
Sarah: What should I do next time?
Vanessa: You should remain calm and keep your cool. Try to change the tone of your voice.
Sarah: He started shouting first! I lost my temper after that.
Vanessa: I know, but he felt like you were ordering him to turn his phone off. I think that a suggestion would work better than a request, don't you agree?
Sarah: Yes, I would rather serve a happy client. I didn't get a tip yesterday.
Vanessa: We may have lost his business, unfortunately. Let's hope he doesn't give us a bad review. We really want to avoid that.
Sarah: How?
Vanessa: Free meals are quite persuasive ...





Let's Practice!

Let's see if Vanessa is persuasive!

Instructions: Read the dialogue again. Select the correct answer.

1. What should Sarah do next time?
 - a. She should start shouting first.
 - b. She should order the customer to turn his phone off.
 - c. She should remain calm and keep her cool.
2. What would work better?
 - a. A suggestion would work better than a request.
 - b. A request would work better than a suggestion.
 - c. An order would be better than a request.
3. What else can be persuasive?
 - a. Shouting
 - b. A free meal
 - c. Losing one's temper.



Let's Practice!

Vanessa is full of good advice!

Instructions: Circle the sentences which express advice. Using the sentences, model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

1. Why did you argue with the client?
2. You ought to treat our clients with the appropriate care.
3. You must change the tone of your voice.
4. You should try to be nicer and more understanding.





Extension Activity

Are you good at giving advice?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Role-play a situation with your partner. Choose one of the roles below.
- Write a dialogue (12 to 14 lines) about the situation.
- Read the dialogue aloud.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I role-play about a restaurant and talk about customer service.

☐ ☐

I offer advice and solutions.

☐ ☐

I am persuasive and change my partner's mind.

☐ ☐

Student A Role	Student B Role
You want to eat at a restaurant but cannot decide on a place. You eventually change your mind after your partner persuades you to follow their advice.	You provide advice and solutions to your partner. You persuade your partner to change their minds about where you want to eat.



Target Words

- out of line** (expression): inappropriate; unacceptable
e.g. The customer's behavior was out of line yesterday.
- reputation** (noun): widespread opinion about something or someone
e.g. Our restaurant's reputation depends on our good customer service.
- to lose one's temper** (expression): to become nervous and angry
e.g. I'm sorry I lost my temper yesterday.
- to lose someone's business** (expression): to not have customers because of a problem
e.g. We may have lost his business, unfortunately.
- persuasive** (adjective): able to persuade and convince others
e.g. A free meal can be very persuasive!
- service industry** (noun): business that provides services or specialized work for customers
e.g. We work in the service industry and we ought to treat our clients with care.





Learning Points

Being Persuasive

When you work in a restaurant or a shop, it is important to be persuasive to be able to change a customer's mind about something.

Remember to be polite and use appropriate expressions to persuade someone.

You use expressions like *Don't you think ... ?* or *Don't you agree ... ?* to convince or persuade someone to change their minds.

You use modals like *should*, *ought to* or *would rather* to suggest what is necessary.

Examples:

- **Ann:** *I'm sorry I lost my temper yesterday.*
- **Bob:** *It's OK, but a good customer is good for business, don't you think?*
- **Ann:** *Yes, I would rather serve a happy client.*
- **Bob:** *You should remember the magic words: Service with a smile! Don't you agree?*

Offering Advice and Solutions

When you work in a restaurant or in a shop, it is important to offer advice and solutions properly.

Remember to offer advice politely and to use the modals *could*, *should* or *might* to propose a solution.

Here is a list of expressions you can use to offer advice and solutions:

- You might want to ...
- Would you mind ... ?
- You should ...
- You ought to ... (strong request)

Examples:

- **Ann:** *What should I do next time?*
- **Bob:** *You should remain calm.*

